Knowledge organiser (TRACK) — One change, named before you make it

Pathway: TRACK · Week 5 Part 1 · Big question: How does naming one specific compositional change before touching the page lead to stronger refinement?

Core studio focus

Family: Identity and studio log

Big question: How does naming one specific compositional change before touching the page lead to stronger refinement?

• Review your Week 4 identity piece against your Week 3 composition plan.

• Write down one targeted improvement before picking up a tool (edge contrast, tonal depth, or background balance).

• Carry out the named refinement and document the before-and-after impact in your studio log.

Essential vocabulary

• refinement: A focused, deliberate adjustment that sharpens clarity, tone, or balance.

• intention: Knowing and stating the exact visual effect you want before making a mark.

• edge quality: How crisp, bold, or soft the boundary is between two shapes.

• accent: A small touch of bright highlight or deep dark that pulls the eye to the focal point.

• audit: Checking your work honestly against your original design goals.

Three-step studio method

Step 1: Compare artwork against the Week 3 plan: I place my Week 4 artwork next to my Week 3 plan and spot that my central emblem's left edge blends into the indigo pattern.

Step 2: Write the named change on the log card: Before picking up a pen, I write: 'Change: Add a warm amber halo and thicken the outer black contour on the left side.'

Step 3: Execute the change and record the result: I add the amber rim and crisp black line, then complete the 'Impact' box explaining how the focal point now pops.